SPORTSWOMEN WHO DESERVES TO BE KNOWN

A selection of greatest female champions of all time

Alice Milliat
EDITIONS

CONTENTS

04 Allyson Félix - USA, Athletism, 31

05 Martina Navrátilová - Czechoslovakia, Tennis, 60

06 Jeannie Longo - France, Cycling, 58

07 Valentina Vezzali - Italy, Foin Fencing, 43

08 Ryōko Tani - Japan, Judo, 41

09 Annika Sörenstam - Sweden, Golf, 46

10 The increase in the interest of women in sport

50% of sportsperson are a sportswoman. However, in the media, in people's minds, in the collective imagination, women are not as well represented as men.

One person in two does not know any active women athletes and when a study was conducted among internet sport communities, asking them "what is the sports personality that inspires you?" 90% answered a sportsmen (and only 38% of women named another woman).

Some sports are made up of legends and some of them are women. Here are a selection of great female champions who have made their mark on their sport.

ALLYSON FÉLIX

Allyson Félix - USA, Athletism, 31

Allyson Félix is the most successful female athlete in the history of the Olympic Games with 7 gold medals, including at least one in the three sprint distances (100 and 200 metres individual, 400 metres relay). A performance that only the Australian Betty Cuthbert had achieved before her. Her record at the World Championships is not to be outdone: 9 titles.

With the American team, she even holds the record for the 4×100 metres achieved at the London Games in 2012. Allyson Félix is considered to be the greatest sprinter in history, both interms of her record and the grace of her stride.

MARTINA NAVRÁTILOVÁ

Martina Navrátilová - Czechoslovakia, tennis, 60

Martina Navrátilová is one of only three tennis players to have completed a Grand Slam (singles, women's doubles and mixed doubles). She is the second most successful player in the history

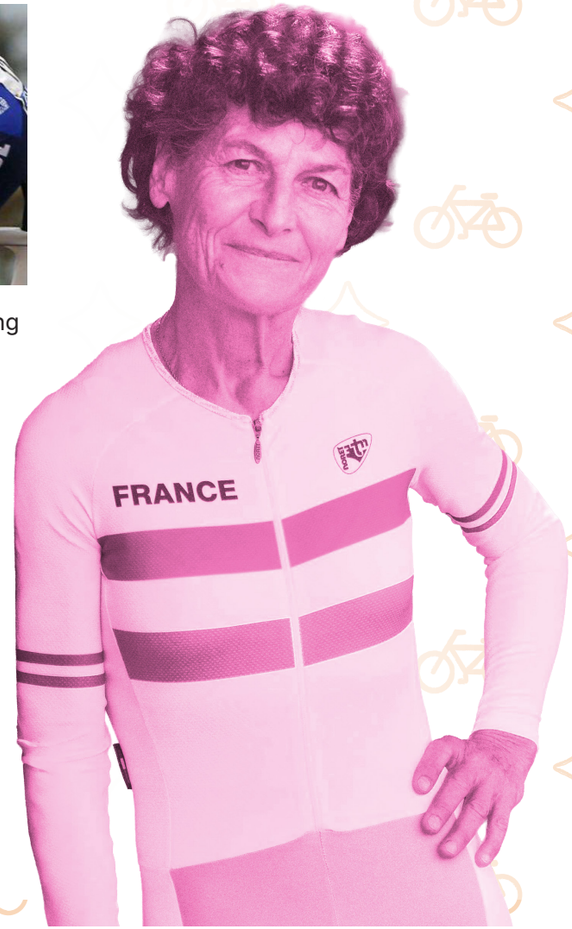
of women's tennis behind Australia's Margaret Smith Court and holds the record for most singles titles with no less than 167 tournaments won in total, including at least 10 per year between 1978 and 1986. Martina Navrátilová has the longest winning streak in tennis history: 74 consecutive matches. Tennis magazine calls her the greatest player of the Open Era.

JEANNIE LONGO

Jeannie Longo - France, cycling, 58

During her career, Jeannie Longo has won 59 national titles, 13 world championship titles and an Olympic title in 1996. She has a total of 1157 victories

since her first cycling licence, including 3 in the Tour de France for women. She has set no less than 38 world records, which earned her the title of Sportswoman of the Century in 2000 and her selection for the International Cycling Union's Hall of Fame. In addition to her unique record, her career is often highlighted for its exceptional longevity, with more than thirty-five years of competition. To this day, she has still not officially retired!



VALENTINA VEZZALI

Valentina Vezzali - Italy, Foil Fencing, 43

Valentina Vezzali is the most successful Italian athlete. She has the most successful record in the history of world fencing with a record of 35 major titles: 6 Olympic gold medals, including 3 individual, 16 world titles, including 6 individual and 13 European titles, including 5 individual. The foilist also won 11 World Cups with 76 events won and 20 Italian national titles. In addition to her sporting achievements, Valentina Vezzali was praised throughout her career - which ended in 2016 - for her extraordinary mental strength.

RYŌKO TANI

Ryōko Tani - Japan, judo, 41

Ryōko Tani is the most successful judo-ka in the history of the sport. She has won 5 Olympic medals - including two titles - and 7 world championship titles. The 1.46m tall Japanese woman, who competes in the under 50kg category, remained undefeated in international competition for 12 years, from the final of the Atlanta Olympic tournament in 1996 to the Olympic semi-finals in Beijing in 2008, where she lost to Alina Alexandra Dumitru of Romania.
9A true star in Japan, Ryōko Tani has played a major role in reviving interest in women's judo in her country.

ANNIKA SÖRENSTAM

Annika Sörenstam - Sweden, Golf, 46

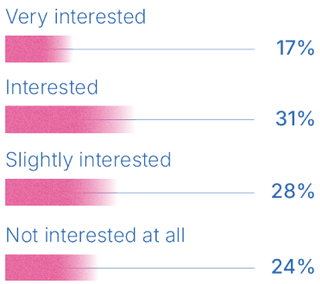
Annika Sörenstam's record is exceptional. She has won 90 tournaments as a professional, making her the most successful golfer in history: 72 victories on the Ladies Professional

Golf Association (LPGA) Tour and 18 other tournaments worldwide. Annika Sörenstam has been named LPGA Golfer of the Year eight times. She is the only golfer to have returned a 59-stroke course card in competition. She also holds the record for the lowest annual stroke average per round, which she set in 2004 at 68.6969.

THE INCREASE IN THE INTEREST OF WOMEN IN SPORT

The presence of female athletes in important positions in sport has done nothing but grow over the last 50 years and as a consequence interest in sport among women has grown significantly.

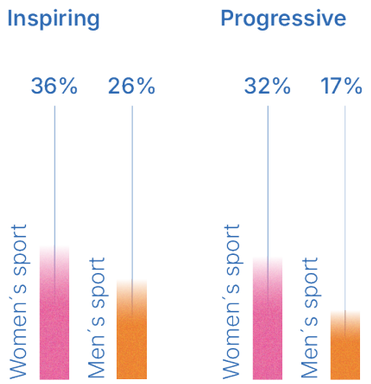
Women under 50



Women over 50

Interest levels in the women's versions of specific sports tend to be greater when men's and women's events are staged together often for example: track and field, tennis, triathlon, mixed martial arts and extreme/action sports.

Of the general population across the eight markets surveyed, 45% would consider attending a live women's sporting event, and 46% said they would watch more if women's sports were accessible on free TV.



Inspiring
36%
26%
Women´s sport
Men´s sport
Progressive
32%
17%
Women´s sport
Men´s sport

Of those who said they had no interest in women's sports, 38% said they hadn't watched, but "could be interested," revealing the potential market for rights holders and other stakeholders to engage those who aren't currently following women's sports.

Attributes associated with women's sports demonstrate several of the values that brands should seek to associate with, further revealing potential for commercial growth in women's sports. Specifically, respondents see women's sports as more progressive and inspiring, less money-driven, more family-oriented and cleaner than men's sports. Women also see women's sports as even more inspiring than men do.

Source: Nielsen Sports - Women's Sports research 2018

Some sports are made up of legends and some of them are women. Here are a selection of great female champions who have made their mark on their sport.

Discover:
Allyson Félix

Martina Navrátilová

Jeannie Longo

Valentina Vezzali

Ryōko Tani

Annika Sörenstam

Did you know:
Alice Joséphine Marie Milliat (1884 – 1957) was a pioneer of women's sport around the world. Her lobbying on behalf of female athletes forced the inclusion of women's events in the Olympic Games. In 1921 she organized the first international women's sporting event in Monte Carlo. She is credited with igniting the pressure on the Olympic Games to allow more female representation in a broader range of sports, a process that is still ongoing today.

Edited in 2021
www.alicemilliat-editions.com

Alice Milliat
EDITIONS